



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*śrutaṃ mayedaṃ prāgeva kṛtā caivodakakriyā |
mā śoke mana ādhatsva eṣa dharmāḥ sanātanaḥ || 74 ||
devānāṃ ca ṛṣīnāṃ ca yogināṃ ca mahātmanām |
martyānāṃ kiṃ punarmātarmā rudastvaṃ tapodhane || 75 ||*

— Skandapurāṇa, Chapter 52, Verses 74-75

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

These verses from the Skandapurāṇa offer profound solace in the face of loss, a universal human experience. Imagine a scene of mourning, perhaps after a loved one has passed. The speaker, likely a sage or wise elder, is comforting a grieving mother, addressing her as “Tapodhane,” one rich in spiritual merit gained through asceticism. This term itself is significant, reminding the mother of her inner strength and accumulated wisdom, qualities that can help her navigate the present sorrow.

The first verse acknowledges that the mother has already heard the teachings on impermanence (“śrutaṃ mayedaṃ prāgeva”) and performed the necessary funerary rites (“kṛtā caivodakakriyā”). These rituals, like offering water to the departed, are not mere formalities, but acts of love and remembrance, helping both the deceased and those left behind to process the transition. The core message is then delivered directly: “mā śoke mana ādhatsva eṣa dharmāḥ sanātanaḥ” – “Do not set your mind on sorrow, this is the eternal law.” It's not a denial of grief, but an invitation to transcend it, to recognize that death is an intrinsic part of the cosmic order.

The second verse amplifies this point by placing death within a broader perspective. It reminds us that even the gods, the ṛṣis (seers), the yogis, and the great souls (mahātmanām) are subject to this universal law. If even these elevated beings cannot escape death, then how much more so are mortal beings (“martyānāṃ kiṃ punarmātarmā rudastvaṃ tapodhane”). The repetition of “mā rudastvaṃ” – “do not weep” – is not a command to suppress emotion, but an encouragement to find strength and acceptance within your spiritual practice. It's a call to remember your true nature, which is beyond the limitations of the physical body and the temporary experience of loss.

In modern life, where we often resist the reality of death and cling tightly to what is fleeting, these verses offer a powerful antidote. They urge you to embrace impermanence, to find solace in spiritual wisdom, and to remember the eternal nature of the soul. When faced with loss, allow yourself to grieve, but also remember the strength you possess, the wisdom you have cultivated, and the interconnectedness of all beings. Turn to your spiritual practice, whatever form it may take, to find comfort and guidance. Let go of excessive sorrow and find peace in the understanding that death is a natural part of the cycle of life.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you cultivate a deeper acceptance of impermanence in your daily life, so that when loss inevitably occurs, you can navigate it with greater grace and wisdom?